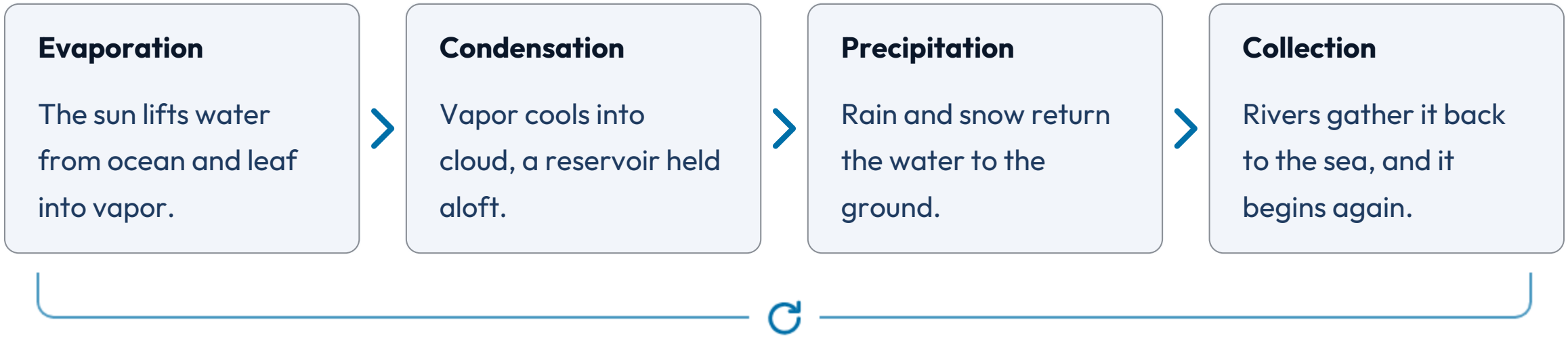
Progression · Timeline · Structure

cycle

A closed loop of 3-6 stages that returns to its start — for a process with no beginning or end, where the last stage feeds the first.

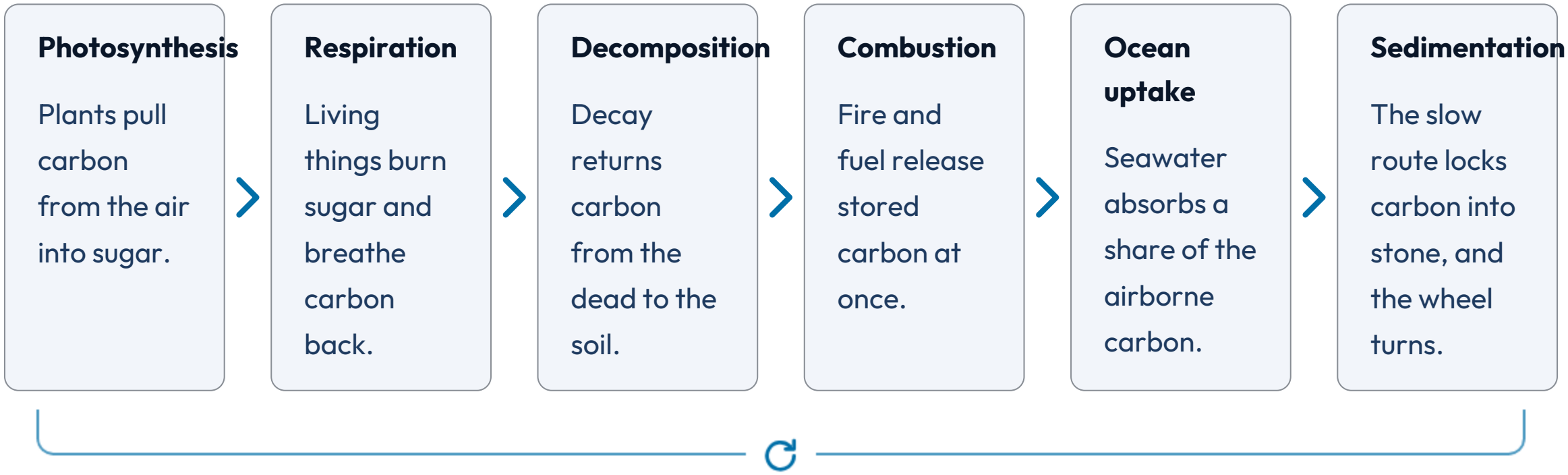
The water cycle

Nothing is spent — only moved.



The carbon cycle

Six stages is the crowded ceiling.



The water cycle

Nothing is spent — only moved.

Evaporation

The sun lifts water from ocean and leaf into vapor.

Condensation

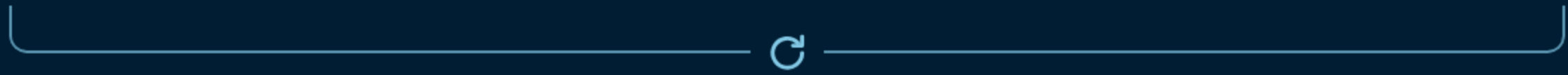
Vapor cools into cloud, a reservoir held aloft.

Precipitation

Rain and snow return the water to the ground.

Collection

Rivers gather it back to the sea, and it begins again.



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When NOT to reach for cycle.

A linear process

If the sequence has a real start and a real end, use list-steps — the numbered spine promises exactly that order. The cycle's closed loop mis-cues a one-way process as recurring.

More than six stages

Past six the ring crowds and the descriptions shrink below legibility. Keep the six load-bearing stages here and push the detail to list-steps or a second slide.

Parallel options

If the items are alternatives the audience weighs rather than stages that flow into each other, use cards-grid or verdict-grid. The arrows here read as causation, not choice.

Related components

See also.

`list-steps` — the process is linear — a real start and finish, not a loop

`timeline-list` — events fixed to dates rather than a repeating cycle

`diagram` — the loop has branches or feedback into non-adjacent stages